

phase for a supercomputer. Your brain doesn't just switch off anymore, it needs that constant stream of information going. You watch something on your PC, enjoy a game or two on the Xbox or PS Vita or whatever console you have; you sink deeper and deeper into the chair as you desperately try to beat the high-score in Super Hexagon and then finally, when you're too drowsy to play, you grab your kindle paper-white and snuggle into bed with it, only sleeping when you nod off with the words a muddle in your mind.

All the key events in your life are seen through the eyes of your camera. Your baby's first steps, you're watching it on your iPhone as you frame the video. Uploading to Instagram and Facebook is second nature and any device which doesn't let you do that is shunned. Companies like Microsoft have even gone to the extent of hinging their entire sales pitch for Windows Phone on that very factor.

The point we're trying to make isn't that technology is taking over our lives, it already has. The point is that we want a screen in front of our eyes no matter where we are and what we're doing. Anything that pulls us out of our digital cocoon is a strict no-no. Touch screens help us consume this content better so they're now the norm; you wouldn't have even considered a smartphone without a keyboard before the iPhone, but now a keyboard is only for the fuddy-duddies on their BlackBerrys (Robert will have blood on his hands when he reads this) who still swear by their keyboards.

To change or not to change

Our devices define our lives, a fancy phone is like a holy totem that you want to keep within reach at all times and never let go. Just caressing it will probably send

waves of pleasure coursing through our bodies and manufacturers want that device to be theirs. The standard designs that we've been used to over the years haven't evolved much, though interfaces have evolved to some extent.

To that end, manufacturers and designers are bending over backwards to find something new and innovative that will be THE device. A new form-factor that will be dominant over everything else and one that they can claim to be the first to introduce. Some of the designs we've seen are downright wonky, others are intriguing and some don't seem to have a point.

As a matter of course, here's a refresher of what you've come to accept as the norm and what you can expect in the near future.

The Classics

The Desktop PC

These were the first devices that gave the first true taste of computing power to the



masses. A PC at home was an unthinkable reality that people weren't willing to believe in during the 1980s, but they got around to it, and how! You still see desktops everywhere and no matter what people will say about the changing face of the PC and the death of the desktop as we know it, they're here to stay for a long time yet.

There is, even now, no viable alternative to the true computing power and convenience that a desktop offers when it comes to doing actual work. Take this article for instance, this author wouldn't have been able to type it out at almost 60 words per minute if it wasn't for the ₹10,000 mechanical keyboard at his fingertips; the designers couldn't have laid this out without the power of InDesign and Photoshop running on a decent PC and even those awesome Showdown Effect and Quake sessions would be a distant memory. A keyboard and mouse combo is still unbeaten when it comes to precision and there's nothing that can be done about it, yet.

Laptops

Laptops haven't evolved much at all these past 10 years. They've gotten slimmer, their battery lasts longer and they've inevitably gotten more powerful over the years. Regardless, they still don't offer

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